Elliott Owens

Onboarding and Implementation | Customer & Employee Onboarding | Training and Change Management

+1 206 375 2720 • elliott.rae@outlook.com • linkedin.com/in/elliottrae • Washington • Remote (US) — based abroad, US work-authorized

SUMMARY

I get new customers and new hires productive fast and keep them that way. I can cut the ramp time, reduce early-stage churn, and catch adoption risk before it costs the account. I take technology rollouts off leadership's plate end-to-end, from site readiness through training to post-launch support, so go-lives land on time without last-minute fires. I absorb a large, constantly shifting workload without things slipping, freeing the team to focus on growth instead of triage.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sephora *Seattle, WA*

People Operations Manager — Store Leadership | *Mar 2021 – Jan 2026*

- **30-day ramp time and Sub-6% turnover**: I rebuilt the new hire onboarding program from a checklist of modules into a structured program with peer-shadow days, manager-led readiness checkpoints, and 30-60-90-day follow-up which cut ramp time from 90 days to 30 while maintaining above 80% new hire satisfaction.
- **6% YoY growth on $15M in annual sales**: owned full-cycle people operations (talent acquisition, onboarding, performance management, workforce planning) for a 40+ person team, serving as the site's primary point of contact for corporate HR and regional leadership on policy rollout and program strategy.
- **24% profit margin**: sustained through Tableau-driven workforce analytics, identifying oversights/risks, guiding payroll, labor budgeting, and staffing decisions with data instead of guesswork.
- **60+ employees trained through a full POS change and technology rollout:** coordinated site readiness across operations, IT, and corporate teams, documented implementation issues and best practices, and served as the primary escalation point for network and system issues through go-live.
- **Consistent internal promotion pipeline:** identified and developed high-potential talent into a repeatable succession track, reducing external hiring need at the leadership level.

Nordstrom *Seattle, WA*

Cosmetics Business Manager | *Oct 2016 – Feb 2021*

- **60% increase in average client transaction value**: built through service-excellence strategies and cross-functional partnership across the sales floor, turning one-time purchases into repeat relationships.
- **$700K+ in combined annual revenue** ($200K for a small cosmetic line, $500K+ for a mid-size line): driven by creative event programming, targeted selling strategies, and an elevated client experience from first visit to repeat customer.
- **Sales unit adoption of a new digital tool**: led the rollout through one-on-one coaching and change management, turning a top-down mandate into a habit the team kept using.
- **Zero compliance issues managing client data** in a CRM platform, maintaining accuracy and privacy standards that supported personalized outreach without cutting corners.

Independent Contracting Services *Remote*

Freelance Brand & Communications Consultant — Remote Program Management | *2013 – Present*

- Independently managed 12+ years of concurrent client engagements fully remote, owning timelines, budgets, and stakeholder communication end-to-end from brief to delivery — the same autonomy, organization, and asynchronous coordination required for distributed work.

- Delivered brand identity, visual communication, and marketing programs for clients across multiple time zones, building durable habits for async communication, self-directed prioritization, and remote stakeholder management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Onboarding and Training Program Design:
· New hire and customer onboarding systems
· Curriculum and job aid development
· Live training design
· 30-60-90 day success framework

Change Management and Technology:
· POS and Software implementation (Xstore and Aloha)
· Cross-functional coordination
· End-User Training

Data and Program Analytics:
· Onboarding and Performance Analytics (Tableau)
· KPI Monitoring
· Compliance and Completion reporting

Distributed Collaboration:
· Asynchronous Program Delivery
· Cross-Time-Zone Coordination
· Autonomous program ownership

EDUCATION

Seattle Pacific University *Seattle, WA*
Bachelor of Arts — Visual Communication Design
Minor: New Media & Social Media Marketing

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Native) | Spanish (B2.1 — conversational, actively developing)
Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript | Tableau | CRM Platforms | macOS, Windows, iOS, Android | XStore and Aloha (POS) | Eightfold AI (ATS)
Time Zone Flexibility: Global
Work Authorization: US citizen; available immediately for fully remote roles.